SHARE
SURVEY OF HEALTH, AGEING AND RETIREMENT IN EUROPE

Qualitative pretesting a multi-lingual questionnaire in one language
Report from an in-house SHARE experiment

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Agenda

1. Why implement QPIs in SHARE?
2. Report from experience of single language QPIs in multi-lingual survey
   - Process
   - Evaluation
3. How to account for multiple languages in QPI procedure

Why implement QPIs in SHARE?

- **S**(urvey) of **H**(ealth), **A**(geing) and **R**(etirement) in **E**(urope):
  - Representative cross-national household panel survey of 50+ population in 27 European countries & Israel
  - Generic questionnaire development in English
  - Translation in 39 language versions
- Addition of new modules → maintenance of high quality
- Introduction of new IT-module in W10 makes a perfect test case

Why implement QPIs in SHARE?

Questionnaire Development in SHARE – so far

- Development of new content in a collaboration of area teams as experts in their field and survey methodologists at SHARE Central

- Cognitive pretests run by external agents in the past (e.g. GESIS) who delivered a report that was integrated in the discussion process
  - Pretest run in single language
  - Report in Generic language

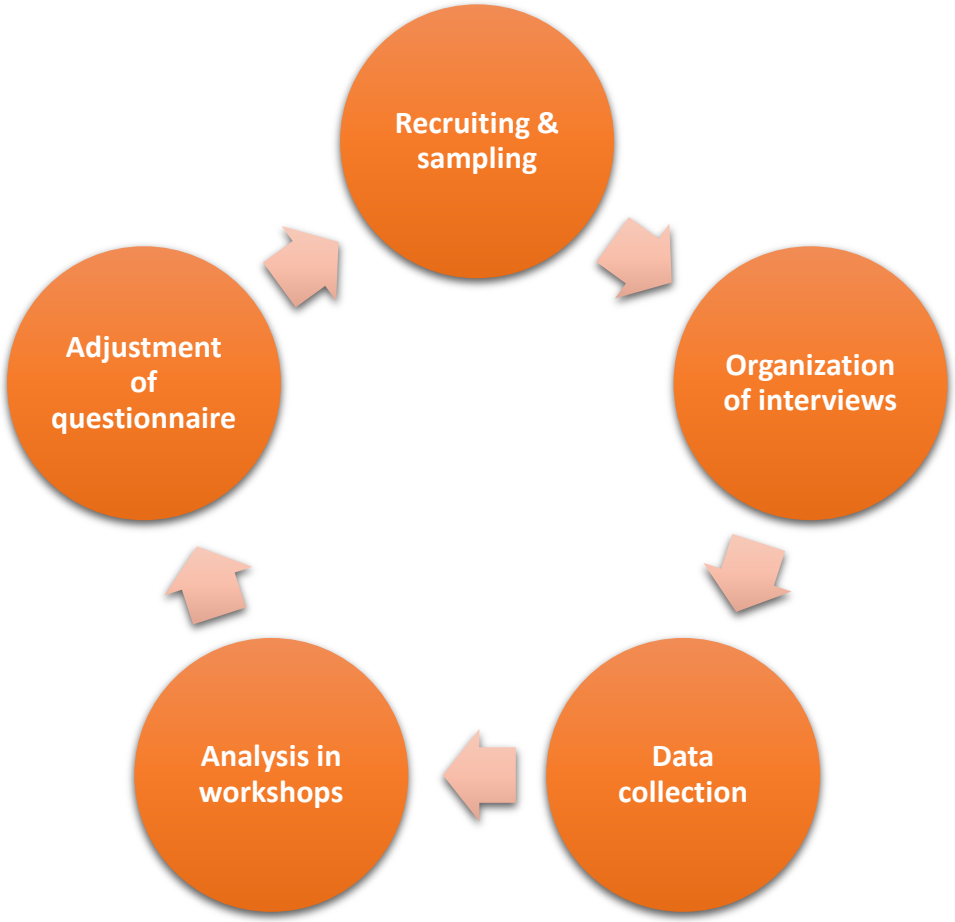
Why implement QPIs in SHARE?

Motivation to do qualitative pretest interviews in-house

- Connecting the researcher's perspective with the respondent's perspective
- Direct involvement of parties participating in usual development process in interviewing lead to first-hand experience how the question wording is perceived
- Use and increase of in-house and SHARE family expertise
- Direct data-based feedback leads to in-depth discussions and well-founded adjustments

How to implement QPIs in SHARE?

- Single language context: German sub-study as test bed
- Recruitment of interviewers within our SHARE team
- Three sessions of interviewer training
- Start of our iterative QPI process



What happened so far?

- 1st round of pretesting the IT-Module questionnaire (16 questions)
- Collection of 17 interviews conducted by 8 in-house interviewers
- Between 16 mins and 120 mins of length (average 45 mins)
- 13 hours and 16 minutes of recordings
- Different modes: mainly face-to-face, but also via Zoom
- Preliminary analysis in workshops
  - Iterative process of listening to recording(s)/reading transcripts ↔ discussion
  - Documentation of results and implementation of improvements in the questionnaire
- Transfer back into Generic questionnaire (English)

What's next?

- In-depth analysis of the data using qualitative methods (e.g. content analysis or sequential analysis)

- 2nd round of QPIs with modified items
  - Evaluation of the changes that were implemented
  - Testing of items that were developed based on the discussion process

Evaluation of single-language QPIs in SHARE

BENEFITS

- Inclusion of two languages in development process
- Disussions in mother tongue enable more nuanced exchange about wording details, connotations, etc.
- Awareness among question developers for cultural and linguistic differences
- Improvement of translation instructions

CHALLENGES

- Exclusion of non-Geman-speaking team members and experts
- Back-transfer to Generic language
  - Risk of losing insights within translation process
  - Time consuming
- No consideration of other SHARE languages – so far

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How to apply QPIs within an international, multilingual survey?

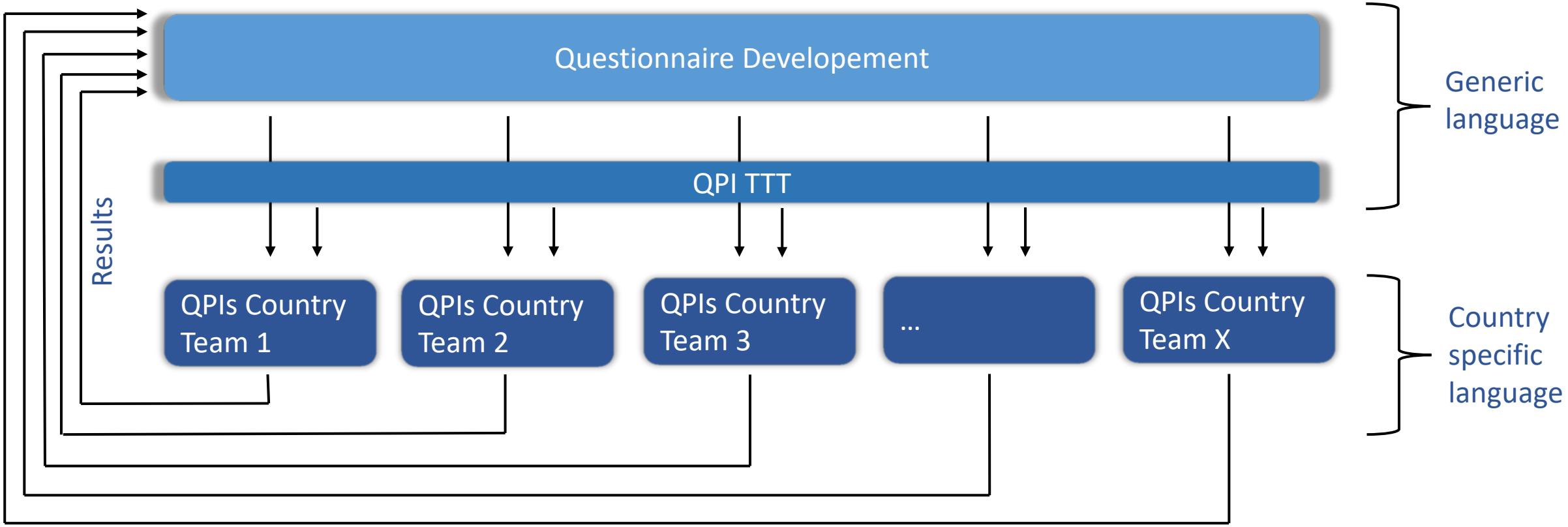
QPIs within a multilingual survey?

In an ideal world…

- QPIs in all 39 language versions in SHARE
- Language groups in SHARE (Dryer and Haspelmath, 2013)
  - Roman languages (French, Italian, Spanish, Romanian, Portuguese)
  - Slavic (Polish, Czech, Serbo-Croatian, Bulgarian, Slovak, Slovenian, Bulgarian, Russian)
  - Baltic languages (Lithuanian, Latvian)
  - Germanic languages (English, Swedish, Danish, Dutch, German)
  - Uralic (Finish, Hungarian, Estonian)
  - Hellenic/ Greek (Greece and Cyprus)
  - Semitic language (Arabic, Hebrew, Maltese)

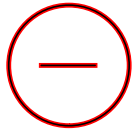
- But:
  - Logistical limitations
  - No represention of all languages in QPI team and QNN development team
  - Indepth analysis work shops are only possible in English

QPIs within a multilingual survey?



QPIs within a multilingual survey?

- Conceptual feedback from a variety of language groups
- Increase in number of interviews
- Inclusion of international team members



- Logistically challenging
- Increased development phase
- Less flexibility for spontaneous changes

→ **Need for additional staff & extra project funding**

Thank you for your attention!

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